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Focus on Older People In and Out of Employment

Manpower Research and Statistics Department
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HIGHLIGHTS

Older Residents at Work

- Recent gains in employment rate stems mainly from the entry of older people into the workforce.

- Education increases employment prospects, particularly among women. The educational profile of older workers has improved significantly but remains weaker than for younger workers.

- Reflecting their weaker educational profile, older workers are concentrated in non-professional, managerial, executive & technician jobs making them more vulnerable to low-wage employment. They are also more likely to be self-employed and work part-time than those younger, but the majority of older workers are still in salaried and full-time employment.

- *Land transport & supporting services*, *administrative & support services* (incl. cleaning and security services) and *restaurants* have the highest incidence of older workers, with more than four in ten of their resident workers aged 50 & over. At the other end, the incidence of older workers is lowest in *IT & other information services*, *electronic products manufacturing* and *financial institutions*.

Older Residents Seeking Work

- Older residents continue to register higher long-term unemployment rate than those younger. Nevertheless, all age groups saw an improvement.

- Almost all older job seekers have worked before, mostly in non-PMET jobs. A sizeable number have left their last job at least two years ago.

- Older job seekers sought employment mainly for financial reasons. They mainly rely on savings and income support from family during their unemployment.

Older Residents Outside the Labour Force

- Retirement and housework are the top reasons for economic inactivity among older residents.

- Income from family members is the main source of financial support for the economically inactive especially among the less educated.

- Majority of older economically inactive women have limited or no labour market experience, suggesting that efforts to help them enter the workforce could be complemented by suitable skills upgrading and work preparation programmes, in addition to facilitating part-time and flexible work options.

FOCUS ON OLDER PEOPLE IN AND OUT OF EMPLOYMENT

1 Introduction

1.1 With rapid ageing and falling fertility, Singapore could potentially face a shortage of manpower which can impede economic growth in the future. In addition, the rise in life expectancy[1] means that older persons will generally need more savings to support themselves in old age. Given these trends, it is important for policy makers to gain a good understanding of the profile of the older population to facilitate the development of programmes to encourage them to stay employed longer.

1.2 This paper examines the characteristics of older people both in and out of employment, including means of financial support, motivation to work and previous work experience of those out of work. It also compares the employment characteristics of the older workers relative to their younger counterparts. Data in the paper pertain to the resident[2] population and are mainly sourced from the Labour Force Survey, which included a number of new questions to capture information such as the reason for and time elapsed since leaving the last job for those not at work, and reason for wanting to get a job among the older job seekers.

2 Overview

Gains in employment rate stems mainly from the entry of older people into the workforce

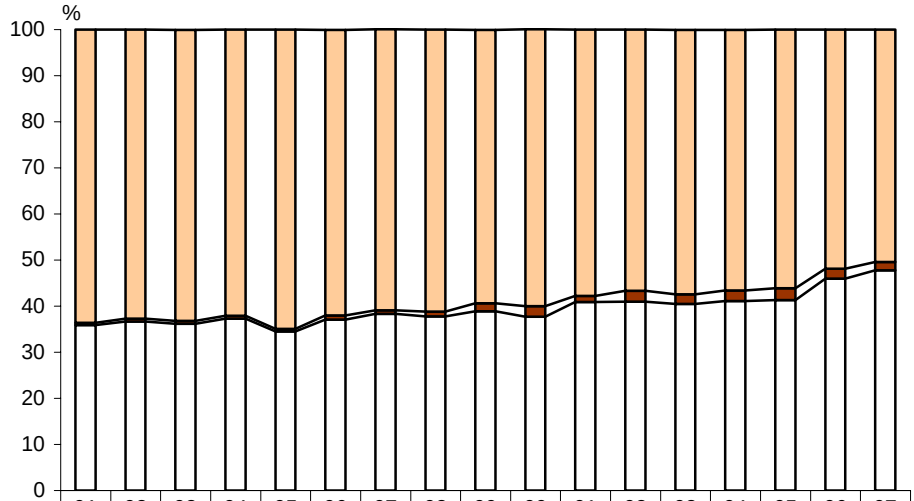
2.1 In Jun 07, 47.8% of the resident population aged 50 & over were employed, surpassing the previous record[3] of 46.0% a year ago. The bulk of the increase (1.5%-points out of 1.8%-points gain) in employment rate stemmed from the entry of older people into the workforce, as evident in the decline in proportion of economically inactive among the older population from 51.9% in Jun 06 to 50.4% in Jun 07. The proportion unemployed dropped by 0.3%-point to 1.8%. Both male and female older residents posted record high employment rate in Jun 07 (Annex A – Chart A1).

[1] For the resident population, life expectancy at age 65 increased from 14.0 years in 1980 to 19.1 years in 2007 (preliminary). Source: Singapore Department of Statistics Website, *Key Indicators on the Elderly Population*, <http://www.singstat.gov.sg/stats/themes/people/elderly.pdf> and Singapore Department of Statistics (2008), *Complete Life Tables 2006 – 2007 for Singapore Resident Population.*

[2] Residents refer to Singapore citizens and permanent residents.

[3] The data series started in 1991.

CHART 1: DISTRIBUTION OF RESIDENT POPULATION AGED 50 AND OVER BY ECONOMIC ACTIVITY STATUS, 1991 TO 2007 (AS AT JUNE) (NON-SEASONALLY ADJUSTED)



	91	92	93	94	95	96	97	98	99	00	01	02	03	04	05	06	07
Economically Inactive	63.6	62.7	63.1	62.1	64.9	61.9	61.0	61.2	59.3	60.1	57.8	56.7	57.3	56.5	56.1	51.9	50.4
Unemployed	0.5	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.9	0.8	1.0	1.7	2.3	1.3	2.3	2.1	2.3	2.6	2.1	1.8
Employed	35.9	36.7	36.2	37.3	34.5	37.1	38.3	37.8	38.9	37.7	40.9	41.0	40.5	41.1	41.3	46.0	47.8

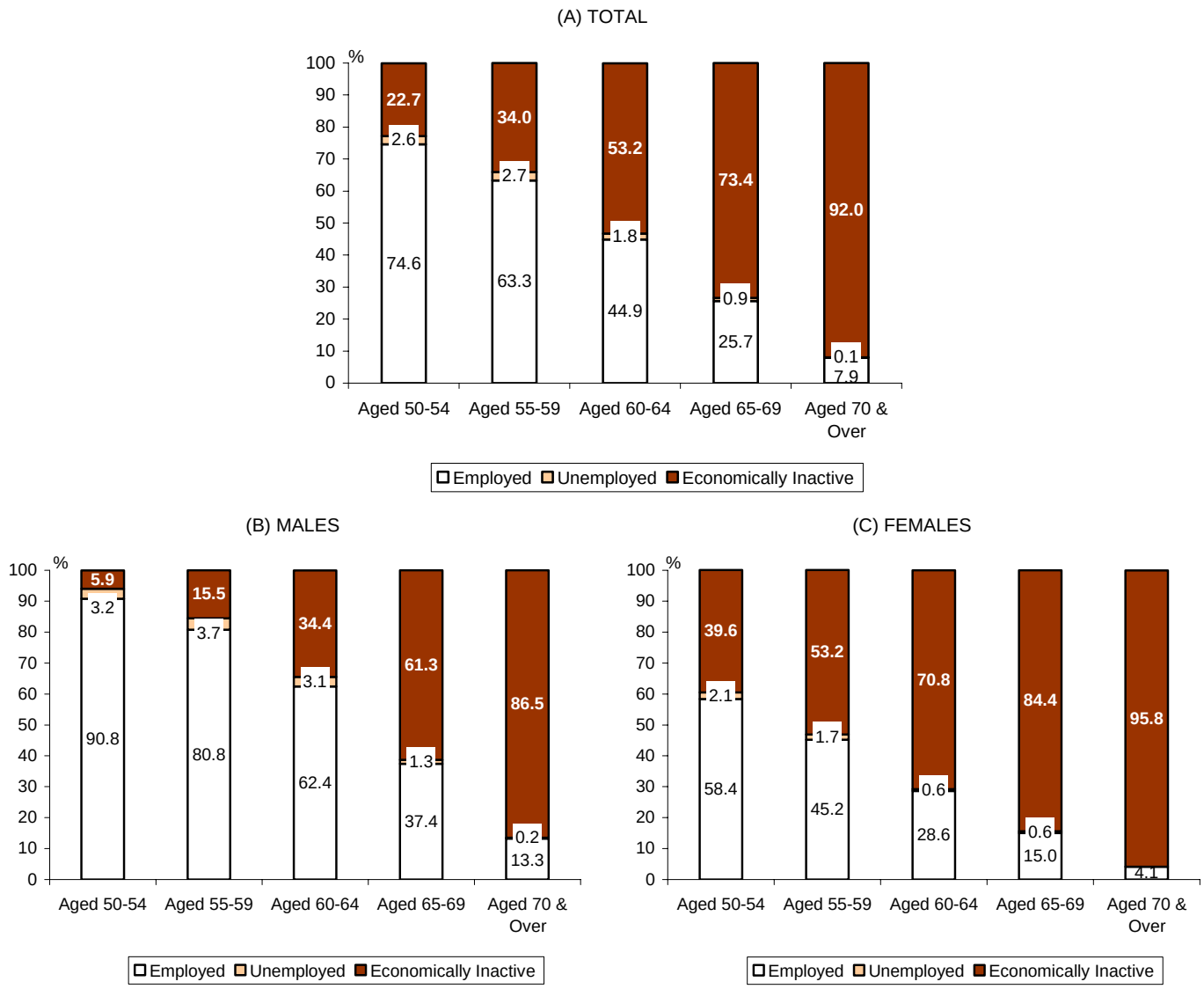
Source: Labour Force Survey (LFS), except data for 1995, 2000 and 2005 which are from the Census of Population 2000 and General Household Survey (GHS) 1995 and 2005.

Notes: (1) Data from Census and GHS may not be strictly comparable with LFS as there are some differences in the survey period. GHS/Census was conducted from Mar/Apr to Aug/Sep whereas LFS was from May to Jul.

(2) The unemployed figures above refer to the percentage of population who were unemployed. This is different from the unemployment rate, which is expressed as a percentage of the labour force.

2.2 The employment rate for both older males and females declined sharply with age, ranging from 90.8% for men aged 50-54 to only 13.3% for those aged 70 & over, and for women from 58.4% to 4.1% respectively. Within each of the finer age groups, older men were far more likely to be working or seeking work than older women (Chart 2B and Chart 2C).

CHART 2: DISTRIBUTION OF OLDER RESIDENT POPULATION BY GENDER, AGE GROUP AND ECONOMIC ACTIVITY STATUS, JUNE 2007



Source: Labour Force Survey, MOM

Note: The unemployed figures above refer to the percentage of population who were unemployed. This is different from the unemployment rate, which is expressed as a percentage of the labour force.

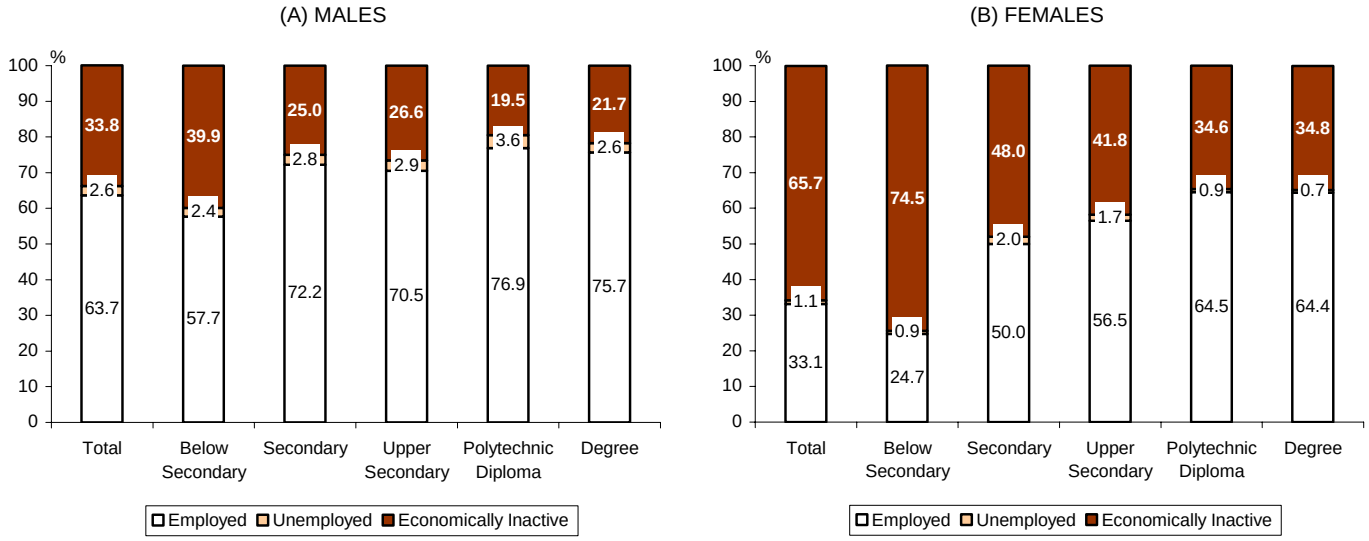
Employment rate of older men is among the highest, but rate for women still lags many other countries

2.3 The employment rate for older men in Singapore was generally higher than in many developed countries except for Japan, South Korea and Sweden. While the rate for older women in Singapore has improved strongly in recent years, they still lagged many other countries. Details are in Annex A – Table A1.

Education increases employment prospects

2.4 Education increases employment prospects, particularly among women. In 2007, nearly two in three women aged 50 & over with tertiary qualifications were employed compared with only one in four among those without secondary qualifications. The link with education was less pronounced for men where over seven in ten of them with at least secondary qualifications were employed compared to 58% for the below secondary group (Chart 3).

CHART 3: DISTRIBUTION OF RESIDENT POPULATION AGED 50 AND OVER BY GENDER, EDUCATIONAL ATTAINMENT AND ECONOMIC ACTIVITY STATUS, JUNE 2007



Source: Labour Force Survey, MOM

Note: The unemployed figures above refer to the percentage of population who were unemployed. This is different from the unemployment rate, which is expressed as a percentage of the labour force.

3 Older Residents at Work

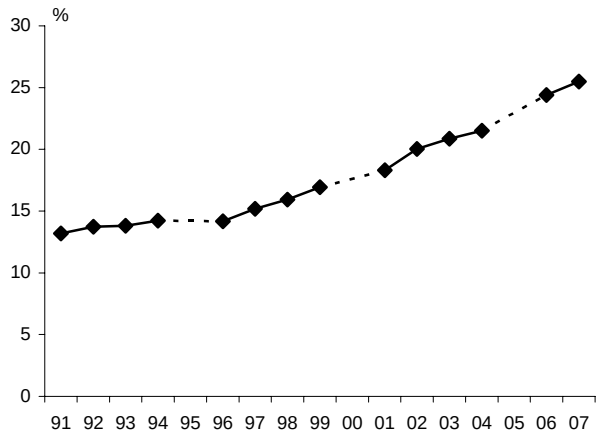
Educational profile of older workers has improved significantly but remains weaker than for younger workers

3.1 In Jun 07, there were 469,400 employed residents aged 50 & over constituting 26% of the resident workforce. Both the number and share increased substantially from 177,500 and 13% in 1991, especially in the last decade when the early batch of post-war baby boomers born between 1947 and 1964 reached 50 and beyond. In the last couple of years, the increase was also helped by the improvement in employment rate of the older population, amid the robust economic conditions and national efforts to enhance their employability. The rapid increase in the older workforce is expected to continue, as the population continues to age and the rest of the post-war baby boomers enter their senior years.

CHART 4: OLDER RESIDENTS IN THE POPULATION AND IN EMPLOYMENT

(A) SINGAPORE RESIDENTS BY AGE GROUP AND GENDER, JUNE 2007

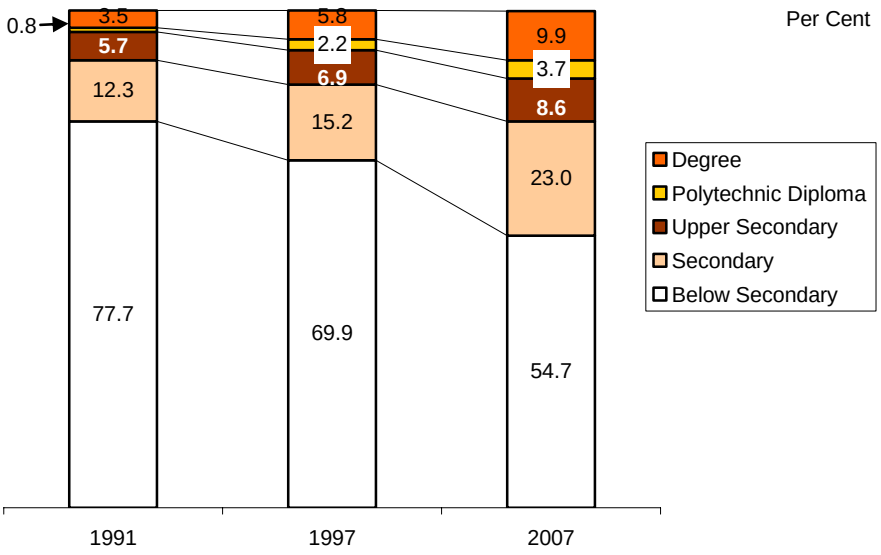
(B) SHARE OF EMPLOYED RESIDENTS AGED 50 AND OVER, 1991 TO 2007 (AS AT JUNE)



Source: Singapore Department of Statistics
Labour Force Survey, MOM

3.2 Supported by growing opportunities for higher education over the years, the educational profile of the older workforce has improved significantly. The proportion of tertiary graduates among employed residents aged 50 & over was 14% in 2007, up from a mere 4.3% in 1991. Conversely, the share of older workers without secondary qualifications fell from 78% in 1991 to 55% in 2007. Nevertheless, their educational profile remained substantially weaker than for the younger workforce aged below 50 where 44% were tertiary educated (Chart 5 and Table 1)

CHART 5: DISTRIBUTION OF EMPLOYED RESIDENTS AGED 50 AND OVER BY EDUCATIONAL ATTAINMENT, 1991, 1997 AND 2007 (AS AT JUNE)



Source: Labour Force Survey, MOM

3.3 Reflecting the higher employment rate for older men, close to two in three (299,700 or 64%) older workers in 2007 were males while the remaining one in three (169,700 or 36%) were females. The gender distribution was more balanced among those younger aged 15 to 49 at 55% for males and 45% for females.

Self-employment a viable option for older workers

3.4 Self-employment is one viable option for older persons to remain in the workforce, given the greater flexibility in working hours that can help older workers make a gradual transition from work to retirement[4]. More than one in four (27%) older workers in 2007 were self-employed, higher than 11% among those aged 15 to 49. The majority of the older self-employed were *own account workers* (17% of all older workers), followed by *employers* (8.3%) and *contributing family workers* (1.4%) (Table 1). Many of the older self-employed were *working proprietors*, *taxi drivers*, *hawkers/stall holders*, *company directors* and *real estate agents*.

Older workers more likely to work part-time

3.5 The majority (90%) of older workers were working full-time. Nevertheless part-time employment was more prevalent among older workers, with one in ten employed residents aged 50 & over working part-time compared to only 4.8% among those younger (Table 1).

[4] Karoly, Lynn A. and Zissimopoulos, Julie (2004), *Self-Employment among Older U.S. Workers*, Monthly Labor Review, Bureau of Labor Statistics, July 2004

TABLE 1: PROFILE OF EMPLOYED RESIDENTS BY GENDER AND AGE GROUP, JUNE 2007

Per Cent

CHARACTERISTICS	Total		Males		Females	
	Aged 15-49	Aged 50 & Over	Aged 15-49	Aged 50 & Over	Aged 15-49	Aged 50 & Over
TOTAL	**100.0**	**100.0**	**100.0**	**100.0**	**100.0**	**100.0**
GENDER						
Males	55.4	63.9	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.
Females	44.6	36.1	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.
EDUCATIONAL ATTAINMENT						
Below Secondary	18.3	54.7	20.1	55.7	16.0	52.9
Secondary	24.1	23.0	22.0	21.0	26.6	26.6
Upper Secondary	14.2	8.6	13.6	7.9	14.8	9.9
Polytechnic Diploma	15.0	3.7	15.8	4.4	14.1	2.6
Degree	28.5	9.9	28.6	11.0	28.5	8.1
EMPLOYMENT STATUS						
Employees	88.6	73.3	85.7	68.3	92.1	82.2
Self-Employed	11.4	26.7	14.3	31.7	7.9	17.8
Own Account Workers	6.8	17.0	8.4	20.9	4.9	10.1
Employers	4.0	8.3	5.5	10.2	2.2	4.9
Contributing Family Workers	0.6	1.4	0.4	0.6	0.8	2.8
NATURE OF EMPLOYMENT						
Full-Time	95.2	89.6	97.4	93.0	92.5	83.6
Part-Time	4.8	10.4	2.6	7.0	7.5	16.4

Source: Labour Force Survey, MOM

Note: n.a. – Not applicable.

Incidence of older workers highest in land transport & supporting services, administrative & support services and restaurants

3.6 Nearly eight in ten (77%) older workers were employed in the services sector in 2007, mainly in *community, social & personal services* (17%), *wholesale & retail trade* (16%), *transport & storage* (14%) and *hotels & restaurants* (11%). In terms of incidence, *land transport & supporting services* (52% pulled up by taxi drivers), *administrative & support services* (42% pulled up by cleaners and security guards) and *restaurants* (41%) had the highest proportion of older workers, with more than four in ten of their resident workers aged 50 & over. At the other end, the incidence of older workers was lowest in *IT & other information services* (5.8%), *electronic products manufacturing* and *financial institutions* (both 12%) (Table 2).

TABLE 2: EMPLOYED RESIDENTS AGED 50 AND OVER BY INDUSTRY, JUNE 2007

INDUSTRY (SSIC 2005)	Number	Incidence (%)	Distribution (%)
TOTAL	**469,400**	**25.5**	**100.0**
MANUFACTURING	**68,400**	**21.8**	**14.6**
Food, Beverages & Tobacco	5,400	30.5	1.2
Paper Products & Printing	6,000	32.0	1.3
Petroleum, Chemical & Pharmaceutical Products	6,200	19.7	1.3
Rubber & Plastic Products	2,600	22.1	0.6
Fabricated Metal Products	4,700	27.9	1.0
Machinery & Equipment	7,100	20.8	1.5
Electrical Products	2,700	23.7	0.6
Electronic Products	11,400	11.7	2.4
Medical & Precision Instruments	1,400	13.8	0.3
Transport Equipment	10,900	31.7	2.3
Other Manufacturing Industries	10,000	33.9	2.1
CONSTRUCTION	**31,400**	**30.3**	**6.7**
SERVICES	**361,800**	**25.8**	**77.1**
Wholesale & Retail Trade	**76,400**	**27.1**	**16.3**
Wholesale Trade	32,700	24.3	7.0
Retail Trade	43,800	29.6	9.3
Transport & Storage	**67,100**	**36.8**	**14.3**
Land Transport & Supporting Services	39,000	52.2	8.3
Water Transport & Supporting Services	9,300	27.2	2.0
Air Transport & Supporting Services	6,400	22.1	1.4
Other Transport & Storage Services	12,300	27.8	2.6
Hotels & Restaurants	**49,400**	**39.4**	**10.5**
Hotels	5,500	29.7	1.2
Restaurants	43,900	41.1	9.4
Information & Communications	**8,700**	**9.6**	**1.8**
Broadcasting & Publishing	2,300	12.7	0.5
Telecommunications	3,300	16.6	0.7
IT & Other Information Services	3,100	5.8	0.7
Financial Services	**14,500**	**12.9**	**3.1**
Financial Institutions	10,500	11.9	2.2
Insurance	4,000	16.6	0.9
Real Estate & Leasing Services	**12,100**	**29.1**	**2.6**
Professional Services	**15,100**	**15.1**	**3.2**
Legal, Accounting & Management Services	6,800	15.8	1.4
Architectural & Engineering Services	4,600	17.3	1.0
Other Professional Services	3,800	12.2	0.8
Administrative & Support Services	**36,800**	**42.3**	**7.8**
Community, Social & Personal Services	**81,600**	**21.3**	**17.4**
Education & Public Administration	35,800	16.0	7.6
Health & Social Services	17,800	24.9	3.8
Other Community, Social & Personal Services	28,000	32.1	6.0
OTHERS*	**7,800**	**37.1**	**1.7**

Source: Labour Force Survey, MOM

Notes: (1) Incidence of older workers refer to the percentage of the resident workforce who were aged 50 & over.
(2) * – Includes Agriculture, Fishing, Quarrying, Utilities and Sewerage & Waste Management.
(3) Shaded cells refer to industries with an above-average incidence of older workers.

Older workers concentrated in lower-skilled jobs

3.7 Reflecting their weaker educational profile, two in three (67%) older workers were employed in non-PMET[5] occupations such as *clerical, sales & service workers* (25%), *production & related workers* (24%) and *cleaners, labourers & related workers* (18%). *Cleaners, labourers & related workers* (57%), *plant & machine operators & assemblers* (43%) and *working proprietors* (41%) had the highest incidence of older workers in their resident workforce. In contrast, only a small proportion of residents working as *professionals* (10%) or *technicians & associate professionals* (15%) were aged 50 & over (Table 3).

TABLE 3: EMPLOYED RESIDENTS AGED 50 AND OVER BY OCCUPATION AND GENDER, JUNE 2007

OCCUPATION (SSOC 2005)	Total			Males			Females		
	Number	Incidence (%)	Distribution (%)	Number	Incidence (%)	Distribution (%)	Number	Incidence (%)	Distribution (%)
TOTAL*	**469,400**	**25.5**	**100.0**	**299,700**	**28.3**	**100.0**	**169,700**	**21.7**	**100.0**
Managers & Administrators	41,300	21.7	8.8	31,600	25.5	10.6	9,700	14.6	5.7
Working Proprietors	32,900	41.2	7.0	27,300	43.0	9.1	5,500	34.1	3.3
Professionals	29,200	10.4	6.2	18,800	11.4	6.3	10,400	9.0	6.1
Technicians & Associate Professionals	53,500	15.3	11.4	32,100	17.8	10.7	21,500	12.6	12.7
Clerical Workers	50,600	20.1	10.8	15,100	26.9	5.0	35,500	18.1	20.9
Service & Sales Workers	66,400	31.2	14.1	39,600	34.2	13.2	26,800	27.6	15.8
Production Craftsmen & Related Workers	37,800	39.3	8.0	34,100	39.5	11.4	3,700	37.8	2.2
Plant & Machine Operators & Assemblers	72,600	42.9	15.5	61,600	46.1	20.6	11,000	30.9	6.5
Cleaners, Labourers & Related Workers	83,800	56.9	17.9	38,400	53.4	12.8	45,500	60.2	26.8

Source: Labour Force Survey, MOM

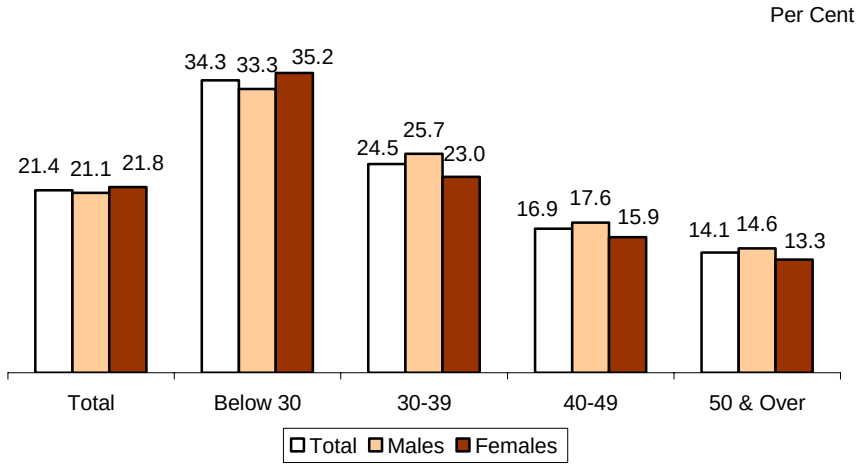
Notes: (1) Incidence of older workers refer to the percentage of the resident workforce who were aged 50 & over.
(2) * – Includes Agricultural & Fishery Workers and Workers Not Classifiable by Occupation which are not separately reflected in the table.
(3) Shaded cells refer to occupations with an above-average incidence of older workers in the respective gender group.

Lower incidence of job change among older workers

3.8 14% of employed residents aged 50 & over in 2007 had changed jobs in the past two years, considerably lower than one in four (25%) for those in their 30s and about one in three (34%) for those younger (Chart 6). Having been in the labour market longer, older workers are more likely to have settled in jobs that better meet their expectations and match their skills and experience. The longer job search period that older persons typically face and the possible loss in wage premium accumulated for the job-specific skills and experience acquired may also discourage them from switching jobs.

[5] PMET refers to *professionals, managers, executives & technicians*.

CHART 6: PROPORTION OF EMPLOYED RESIDENTS* WHO HAD CHANGED JOBS IN THE LAST TWO YEARS BY GENDER AND AGE GROUP, JUNE 2007



Source: Labour Force Survey, MOM

Note: * – Data exclude full-time National Servicemen.

Older employees more likely to be on term contracts than those younger

3.9 Older employees were more likely to be on term contracts[6] than those younger. 16% of resident employees aged 50 & over in 2007 were employed on a term contract basis compared to 9.0% for those aged 25 to 49 (Table 4). This partly reflects their weaker educational profile and the tendency for older workers to move to jobs of a more casual or flexible nature as they make a gradual transition towards retirement. Expectedly, term contract employment was more prevalent among older employees with below secondary qualifications than those more educated.

[6] Employees on term contracts refer to those on fixed-term contract of employment that will terminate on the expiry of a specific term unless it is renewed, as well as those on casual/on-call employment (i.e. where persons are employed on ad-hoc basis, as and when the company requires additional manpower). On the other hand, permanent employees refer to those employed for an unspecified duration, i.e. they are not on term contracts.

TABLE 4: DISTRIBUTION OF RESIDENT EMPLOYEES* BY TYPE OF EMPLOYMENT AND AGE GROUP, JUNE 2007

Per Cent

TYPE OF EMPLOYMENT	Aged 15-24	Aged 25-49	Aged 50 & Over				
			Total	Below Secondary	Secondary	Upper Secondary/ Polytechnic Diploma	Degree
TOTAL	**100.0**	**100.0**	**100.0**	**100.0**	**100.0**	**100.0**	**100.0**
Permanent	69.4	91.0	84.4	80.8	88.9	89.1	88.6
Term Contract	30.6	9.0	15.6	19.2	11.1	10.9	11.4
Less than 1 year (including casual/on-call employment)	22.3	3.6	9.7	13.6	6.2	4.1	3.3
Less than 3 months (including casual/on-call employment)	15.1	2.7	8.6	12.3	5.1	3.4	1.8
3 months to less than 6 months	4.5	0.5	0.5	0.6	0.3	0.2	1.0
6 months to less than 1 year	2.7	0.5	0.6	0.6	0.8	0.5	0.5
1 year or more	8.3	5.3	5.8	5.6	4.9	6.9	8.0
1 year	3.8	1.8	2.4	2.2	2.5	3.1	2.8
More than 1 year to 2 years	2.1	1.6	1.4	1.4	1.2	1.5	1.6
More than 2 years	2.5	2.0	2.0	1.9	1.2	2.3	3.7

Source: Labour Force Survey, MOM

Notes: (1) * – Data exclude full-time National Servicemen.

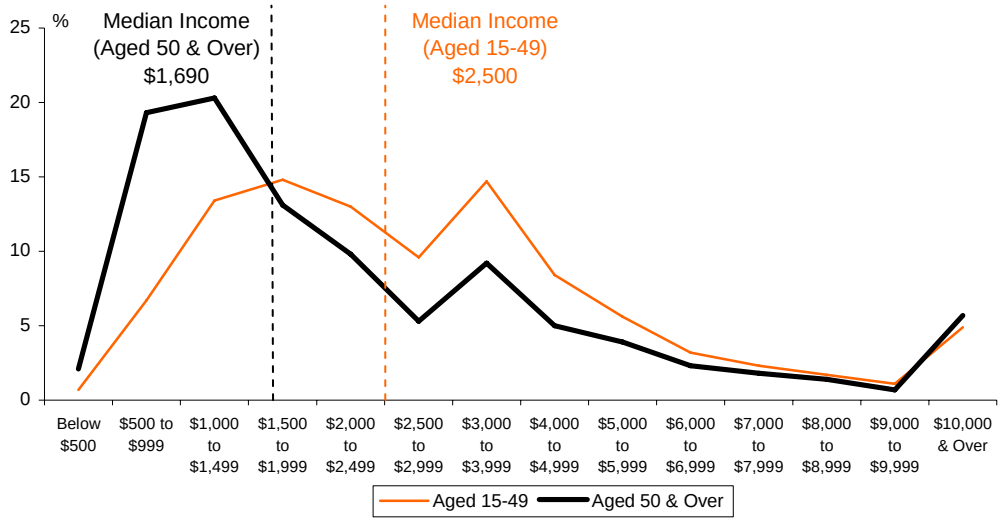
(2) Employees on term contracts refer to those on fixed-term contract of employment that will terminate on the expiry of a specific term unless it is renewed, as well as those on casual/on-call employment (i.e. where persons are employed on ad-hoc basis, as and when the company requires additional manpower). On the other hand, permanent employees refer to those employed for an unspecified duration, i.e. they are not on term contracts.

Proportionately more older workers in lower income groups

3.10 Reflecting the weaker educational profile of older workers and their concentration in lower-skilled occupations, slightly more than one in three (35%) full-time employed residents aged 50 & over were in low-wage employment earning less than or equal to $1,200[7]. This is more than double the 15% share among those aged 15 to 49. A distribution of older workers across the various income brackets showed a higher proportion of them (42%) earning $1,499 & below than those younger (21%). Their share in the remaining income spectrum was lower, except for the highest bracket of $10,000 & over where the share of older workers at 5.7% exceeded the 4.9% for those younger (Chart 7). Detailed data are at Annex A – Table A2.

[7] $1,200 is the 20th percentile income of all full-time employed residents (excl. full-time National Servicemen).

CHART 7: DISTRIBUTION OF FULL-TIME EMPLOYED RESIDENTS* BY GROSS MONTHLY INCOME AND AGE GROUP, JUNE 2007



Source: Labour Force Survey, MOM

Note: * – Data exclude full-time National Servicemen.

4 Older Residents Seeking Work

Older persons more vulnerable to long-term unemployment

4.1 Close to one in four (23%) numbering 17,800 of the unemployed residents in Jun 07 were aged 50 & over. At 3.6%, the unemployment rate for this group was higher than the rate for residents in their 30s (3.0%) and 40s (3.2%) but lower than for younger residents aged below 30 (6.6%) where many are entering the labour market for the first time and even after starting work, tend to seek more frequent job changes. However, once out of a job, older persons tend to remain unemployed longer. Consequently, they were more susceptible to long-term unemployment[8] (Table 5).

TABLE 5: RESIDENT UNEMPLOYMENT AND LONG-TERM UNEMPLOYMENT BY AGE GROUP, JUNE 2007

AGE GROUP (YEARS)	Unemployed			Long-Term Unemployed				Median Duration of Unemployment (Weeks)
	Number	Rate (%)	Distribution (%)	Number	Rate (%)	Share (%)*	Distribution (%)	
TOTAL	**76,100**	**4.0**	**100.0**	**12,100**	**0.6**	**15.9**	**100.0**	**8.0**
Below 30	26,100	6.6	34.3	1,600	0.4	6.3	13.5	4.0
30-39	15,500	3.0	20.4	2,400	0.5	15.2	19.4	8.0
40-49	16,700	3.2	21.9	3,700	0.7	22.0	30.3	10.0
50 & Over	17,800	3.6	23.3	4,500	0.9	25.1	36.8	9.0

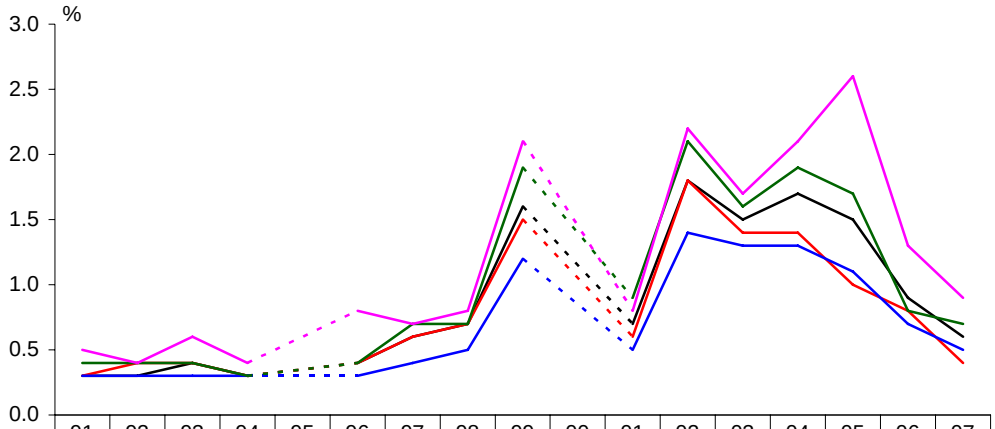
Source: Labour Force Survey, MOM

Note: * – Refer to the proportion of unemployed residents who are long-term unemployed.

[8] Long-term unemployed persons refer to those who have been unemployed for 25 weeks or more.

4.2 While the strong economic performance in recent years has lifted employment prospects for older residents, they continued to register higher long-term unemployment rate[9] than those younger. Nevertheless, all age groups saw an improvement (Chart 8).

CHART 8: RESIDENT LONG-TERM UNEMPLOYMENT RATE BY AGE GROUP, 1991 TO 2007 (AS AT JUNE)



	91	92	93	94	95	96	97	98	99	00	01	02	03	04	05	06	07
Total	0.3	0.3	0.4	0.3		0.4	0.6	0.7	1.6		0.7	1.8	1.5	1.7	1.5	0.9	0.6
Below 30	0.3	0.4	0.4	0.3		0.4	0.6	0.7	1.5		0.6	1.8	1.4	1.4	1.0	0.8	0.4
30-39	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.3		0.3	0.4	0.5	1.2		0.5	1.4	1.3	1.3	1.1	0.7	0.5
40-49	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.3		0.4	0.7	0.7	1.9		0.9	2.1	1.6	1.9	1.7	0.8	0.7
50 & Over	0.5	0.4	0.6	0.4		0.8	0.7	0.8	2.1		0.8	2.2	1.7	2.1	2.6	1.3	0.9

Source: Labour Force Survey (LFS), except data for 2005 which are from the General Household Survey (GHS) 2005.

Nearly all older job seekers have work experience

4.3 In Jun 07, practically all (99%) unemployed residents aged 50 & over had worked before. Reflecting their weaker educational profile, the majority of the older job seekers with work experience were previously employed in non-PMET occupations such as *cleaners, labourers & related workers* (19%), *plant & machine operators & assemblers* (15%), *service & sales* (14%) *and clerical* (13%) *workers*. Only a minority were *professionals* (4.2%) or *technician & associate professionals* (9.7%). Nevertheless, there was a significant percentage (13%) previously working as *managers, working proprietors & senior officials*.

4.4 Close to two in three (66%) older job seekers with work experience had last worked in the *services* sector, mainly in *hotels & restaurants* (14%), *community, social & personal services* (13%), *wholesale & retail trade* (12%) and *transport & storage* (10%). Another 22% and 11% were previously working in *manufacturing* and *construction* respectively (Table 6).

[9] Refers to the share of long-term unemployed (i.e. those unemployed for at least 25 weeks) in the resident labour force.

TABLE 6: UNEMPLOYED RESIDENTS* AGED 50 AND OVER BY PREVIOUS INDUSTRY AND OCCUPATION, JUNE 2007

CHARACTERISTICS	Number	Distribution (%)
TOTAL^	**17,500**	**100.0**
PREVIOUS INDUSTRY (SSIC 2005)		
MANUFACTURING	3,900	22.1
CONSTRUCTION	2,000	11.3
SERVICES	11,500	65.5
Wholesale & Retail Trade	2,100	11.8
Transport & Storage	1,800	10.3
Hotels & Restaurants	2,500	14.1
Information & Communications	400	2.1
Financial Services	400	2.3
Real Estate & Leasing Services	200	1.4
Professional Services	500	2.7
Administrative & Support Services	1,400	7.8
Community, Social & Personal Services	2,300	13.0
PREVIOUS OCCUPATION (SSOC 2005)		
Managers, Working Proprietors & Senior Officials	2,200	12.5
Professionals	700	4.2
Technicians & Associate Professionals	1,700	9.7
Clerical Workers	2,200	12.6
Service & Sales Workers	2,400	13.5
Production Craftsmen & Related Workers	2,000	11.7
Plant & Machine Operators & Assemblers	2,700	15.4
Cleaners, Labourers & Related Workers	3,400	19.4

Source: Labour Force Survey, MOM

Notes: (1) * – Among those with previous work experience only.

(2) ^ – Includes other industries (Agriculture, Fishing, Quarrying, Utilities and Sewerage & Waste Management) and other occupations (Agricultural & Fishery Workers and Workers Not Classifiable by Occupation) which are not separately reflected in the breakdown by previous industry and previous occupation respectively.

4.5 Reflecting the high concentration of the less educated among older job seekers, nearly eight in ten (78%) unemployed residents aged 50 & over were looking for non-PMET jobs such as *cleaners, labourers & related* (22%), *service & sales* (17%) or *clerical* (16%) positions (Table 7).

TABLE 7: UNEMPLOYED RESIDENTS BY AGE GROUP AND TYPES OF JOBS THEY WERE LOOKING FOR, JUNE 2007

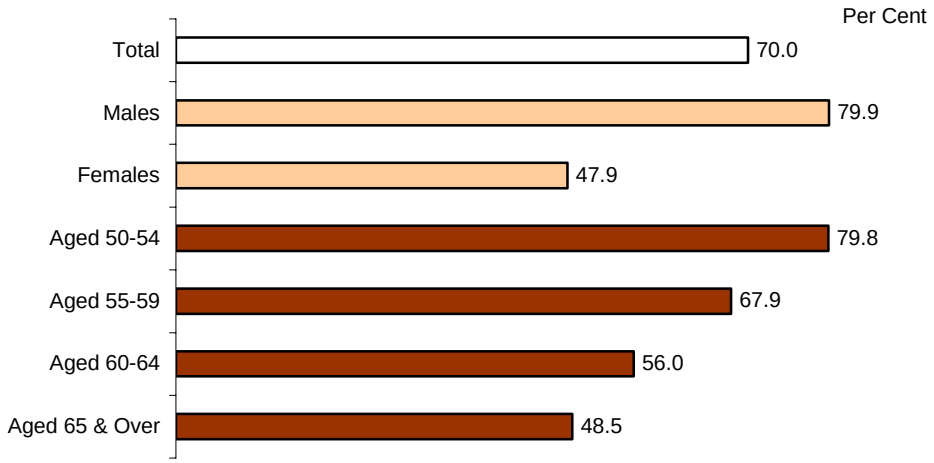
OCCUPATIONAL GROUP (SSOC 2005)	Types of Jobs Looked For					
	Total		Aged 15-49		Aged 50 & Over	
	Number	Distribution (%)	Number	Distribution (%)	Number	Distribution (%)
TOTAL*	**76,100**	**100.0**	**58,300**	**100.0**	**17,800**	**100.0**
Managers, Working Proprietors & Senior Officials	6,200	8.1	5,000	8.7	1,100	6.3
Professionals	9,500	12.5	8,500	14.6	1,000	5.7
Technicians & Associate Professionals	13,700	18.0	11,900	20.4	1,800	10.1
Clerical Workers	15,200	19.9	12,400	21.2	2,800	15.7
Service & Sales Workers	12,800	16.8	9,700	16.6	3,100	17.2
Production Craftsmen & Related Workers	3,900	5.1	2,100	3.6	1,800	9.9
Plant & Machine Operators & Assemblers	6,900	9.0	4,600	7.9	2,300	12.9
Cleaners, Labourers & Related Workers	8,000	10.5	4,000	6.9	3,900	22.2

Source: Labour Force Survey, MOM

Note: * – Includes Agricultural & Fishery Workers and Workers Not Classifiable by Occupation which are not separately reflected in the table.

4.6 In the Jun 06 Labour Force Survey, older job seekers were asked whether they were looking for full-time or part-time work. Seven in ten job seekers aged 50 & over were seeking full-time employment. However, this masked important differences by gender and finer age group. The proportion seeking full-time job dropped sharply to 49% for those aged 65 & older. More women (52%) were also looking for part-time jobs than men (20%) (Chart 9).

CHART 9: PERCENTAGE OF UNEMPLOYED RESIDENTS AGED 50 AND OVER SEEKING FULL-TIME EMPLOYMENT BY GENDER AND AGE GROUP, JUNE 2006

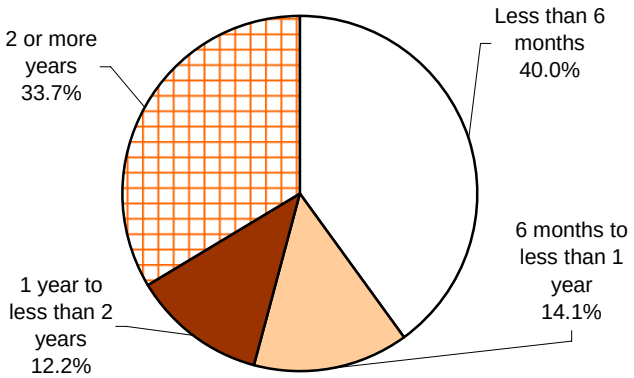


Source: Labour Force Survey, MOM

A sizeable number of older unemployed have left their last job at least two years ago

4.7 The majority of the older job seekers with work experience had worked within the last year, with 40% (7,000) having left their last job less than 6 months ago and another 14% (2,500) who left 6 months to less than a year ago in Jun 07. Nevertheless, there is a sizeable group of 34% (5,900) who had not worked for at least 2 years.[10] **Given that skills obsolescence is likely to set in the longer one is out of work, it is important for older job seekers to upgrade their skill sets to enhance their chances of securing employment.** Unfortunately, only 13% of job seekers aged 15 to 64 had participated in training over the 12-month period ending Jun 07.

CHART 10: DISTRIBUTION OF UNEMPLOYED RESIDENTS* AGED 50 AND OVER BY TIME ELAPSED SINCE THEY LEFT THEIR LAST JOB, JUNE 2007



Source: Labour Force Survey, MOM

Note: * – Among those with previous work experience only.

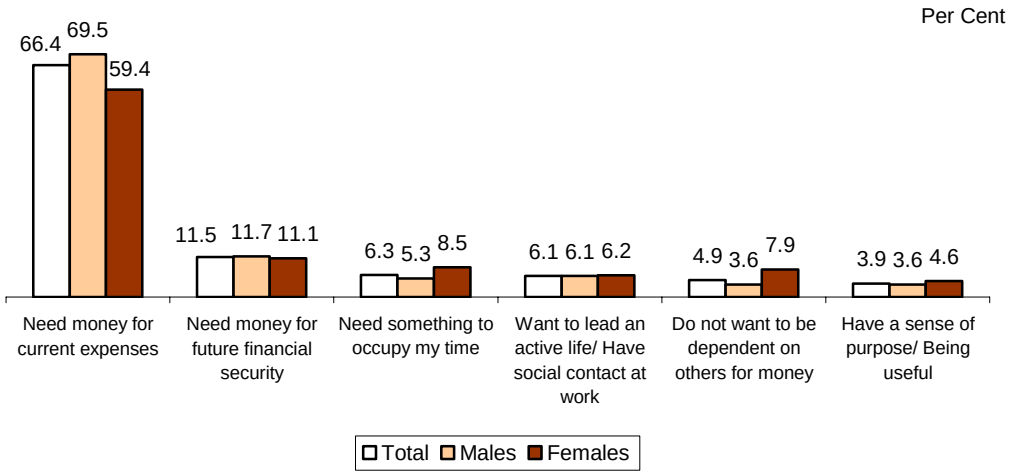
Older job seekers want to work mainly for financial reasons

4.8 The vast majority of older job seekers sought employment mainly because of financial considerations. Two in three (66%) job seekers aged 50 & over in Jun 06 wanted to work mainly because they needed money for current expenses. Another 12% sought work for future financial security. Only a minority cited non-monetary factors such as needing to occupy time (6.3%), wanting to lead an active life/have social contact at work (6.1%), or having a sense of purpose/being useful (3.9%) as their main reason for seeking work (Chart 11).

4.9 Expectedly, more of the less educated sought work because they needed money for current expenses. While this was also the top reason for seeking employment among older unemployed degree holders, the proportion (37%) indicating this was significantly less than those with secondary and below qualifications (70 to 75%). Relative to other educational groups, the degree holders were more likely to cite the need for future financial security and non-monetary reasons, such as wanting to lead an active life or having social contact at work (Annex A – Table A3)

[10] This does not represent duration of unemployment as the job seekers may not necessarily have been seeking work throughout the entire period.

CHART 11: UNEMPLOYED RESIDENTS AGED 50 AND OVER BY MAIN REASON FOR WANTING TO GET A JOB AND GENDER, JUNE 2006



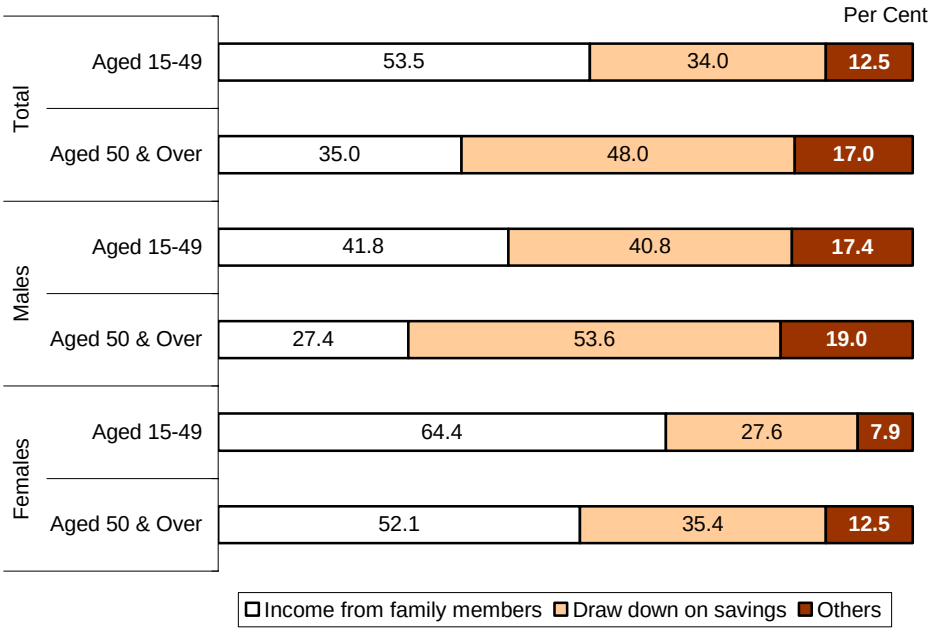
Source: Labour Force Survey, MOM

Note: Figures for each gender do not add up to 100% as other reasons with negligible responses are not shown.

Older job seekers mainly relied on savings and income from family members

4.10 Nearly half (48%) of the older unemployed residents aged 50 & over relied on savings as their main source of financial support in 2006. Another 35% largely depended on income from family members. In contrast, younger job seekers aged 15 to 49 relied more on income from their family members (54%) than savings (34%) (Chart 12).

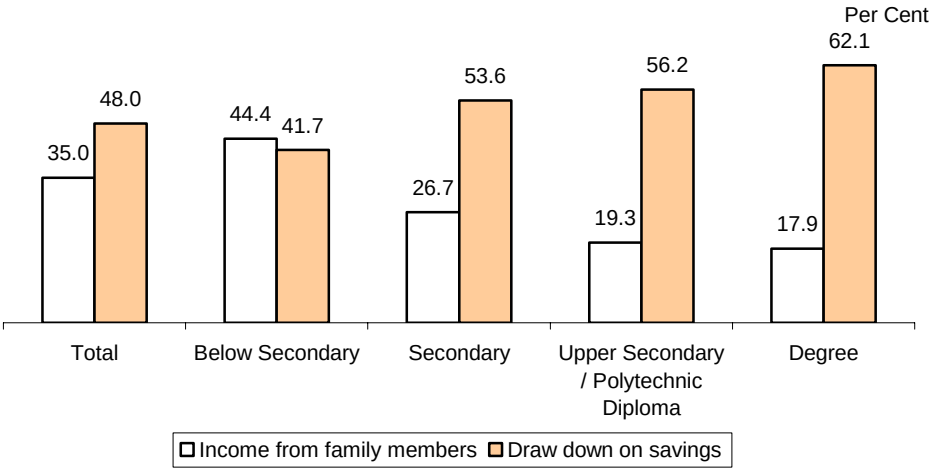
CHART 12: MAIN SOURCE OF FINANCIAL SUPPORT FOR UNEMPLOYED RESIDENTS BY GENDER AND AGE GROUP, JUNE 2006



Source: Labour Force Survey, MOM

4.11 Reflecting the higher income that better educated persons typically command which allow them to accumulate more savings, more than six in ten (62%) resident unemployed degree holders aged 50 & over mainly depended on savings to tide them during their unemployment period. At the other end, the top source of financial support for older job seekers with below secondary qualifications was income from family members (44%) trailed closely by savings (42%) (Chart 13).

CHART 13: MAIN SOURCE OF FINANCIAL SUPPORT FOR UNEMPLOYED RESIDENTS AGED 50 AND OVER BY EDUCATIONAL ATTAINMENT, JUNE 2006



Source: Labour Force Survey, MOM

5 Older Residents Outside the Labour Force

Retirement and housework are the top reasons for economic inactivity among older residents

5.1 In Jun 07, about half or 495,300 of the residents aged 50 & over were economically inactive. This included 219,600 who were aged 50 to 64 comprising 50,500 men and 169,200 women. Close to six in ten (58%) of the economically inactive men aged 50 to 64 gave retirement as their main reason for not working or looking for work, followed by poor health (23%). Reflecting women's role as the primary homemaker and care-giver, three in four (76%) of the older women outside the labour force cited family responsibilities (namely housework, childcare, care of elderly or sick relatives) as their main reason for inactivity, trailed by retirement (9.1%) and poor health (8.0%) (Table 8).

TABLE 8: OLDER ECONOMICALLY INACTIVE RESIDENTS BY MAIN REASON FOR ECONOMIC INACTIVITY AND GENDER, JUNE 2007

(A) AGED 50 AND OVER

MAIN REASON FOR ECONOMIC INACTIVITY	Total		Males		Females	
	Number	Distribution (%)	Number	Distribution (%)	Number	Distribution (%)
TOTAL	**495,300**	**100.0**	**158,900**	**100.0**	**336,500**	**100.0**
Housework	170,100	34.4	100	0.1	170,100	50.5
Retired	133,000	26.9	95,200	59.9	37,800	11.2
Too old	101,000	20.4	29,800	18.7	71,200	21.2
Poor health	48,000	9.7	21,500	13.5	26,500	7.9
Childcare	15,300	3.1	200	0.2	15,100	4.5
Permanently ill/disabled	9,500	1.9	5,000	3.2	4,500	1.3
Care of elderly or sick relatives	6,500	1.3	1,300	0.8	5,200	1.5
Others	11,900	2.4	5,800	3.7	6,100	1.8

(B) AGED 50 TO 64

MAIN REASON FOR ECONOMIC INACTIVITY	Total		Males		Females	
	Number	Distribution (%)	Number	Distribution (%)	Number	Distribution (%)
TOTAL	**219,600**	**100.0**	**50,500**	**100.0**	**169,200**	**100.0**
Housework	113,900	51.9	–	0.1	113,900	67.3
Retired	44,400	20.2	29,000	57.5	15,400	9.1
Poor health	25,300	11.5	11,700	23.3	13,500	8.0
Childcare	10,900	5.0	200	0.3	10,700	6.3
Too old	6,400	2.9	1,500	2.9	4,900	2.9
Care of elderly or sick relatives	5,200	2.3	1,000	2.0	4,200	2.5
Permanently ill/disabled	4,300	2.0	2,400	4.7	2,000	1.2
Others	9,300	4.2	4,700	9.3	4,600	2.7

Source: Labour Force Survey, MOM

Note: '–': Nil or negligible.

Income from family members is the main source of financial support for the economically inactive

5.2 Unlike older job seekers who mostly relied on savings during their unemployment, the majority (76%) of economically inactive residents aged 50 & over in Jun 06 mainly relied on income support from family members. Proportionately more economically inactive older females (84%) depended on income support from family than their male counterparts (61%).

TABLE 9: MAIN SOURCE OF FINANCIAL SUPPORT FOR ECONOMICALLY INACTIVE RESIDENTS BY GENDER AND AGE GROUP, JUNE 2006

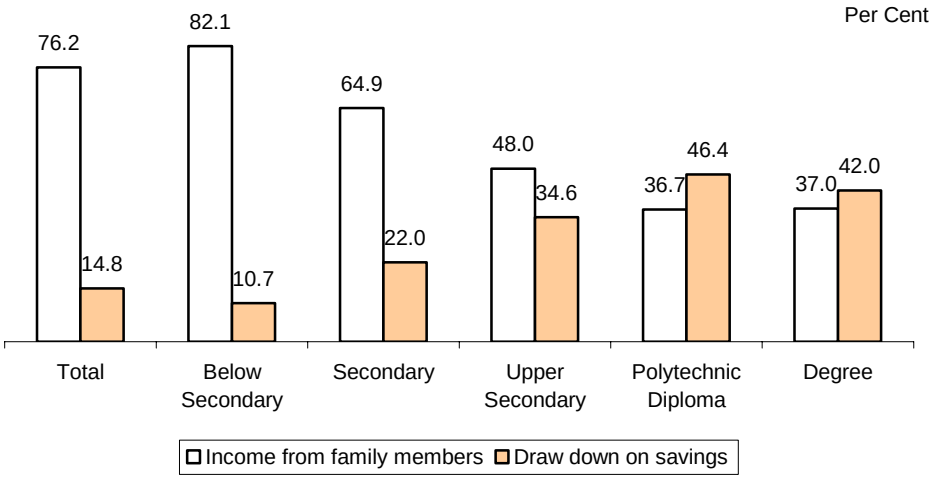
MAIN SOURCE OF FINANCIAL SUPPORT	Total		Males		Females	
	Aged 15-49	Aged 50 & Over	Aged 15-49	Aged 50 & Over	Aged 15-49	Aged 50 & Over
TOTAL	**100.0**	**100.0**	**100.0**	**100.0**	**100.0**	**100.0**
Income from family members	94.3	76.2	93.1	60.8	95.0	83.9
Draw down on savings	3.3	14.8	3.8	25.4	3.0	9.5
Cash allowances from relatives/ friends	0.8	2.9	1.0	3.1	0.7	2.7
Rental income	0.2	1.0	0.1	1.4	0.2	0.8
Interest/ dividends	–	0.9	–	1.4	–	0.7
Did odd jobs	0.5	0.7	0.8	1.6	0.4	0.2
Financial assistance from Government, CDCs, Self-help Groups	0.3	0.6	0.4	1.2	0.2	0.3
Retrenchment benefits	–	0.5	–	1.0	–	0.2
Borrow from relatives/ friends/ financial institutions	0.1	0.1	0.2	0.2	0.1	0.1
Pawned valuable items	0.1	0.1	0.1	–	0.1	0.1
Others	0.4	2.3	0.4	3.8	0.4	1.5

Source: Labour Force Survey, MOM

Note: '–': Nil or negligible.

5.3 The high percentage of older economically inactive residents who relied on income support from family largely reflects the concentration of the less educated among them. More than eight in ten (82%) economically inactive residents aged 50 & over with below secondary qualifications mainly depended on income support from family, much higher than 37% among the tertiary educated. In contrast, the top source of financial support for tertiary educated older residents was savings (polytechnic diploma: 46%; degree: 42%) (Chart 14). **This finding confirms the importance of the family unit as a key pillar of financial support for the economically inactive, especially among the less educated who are likely to have difficulty accumulating sufficient savings for old age. It also underscores the importance of job re-design and training to enhance the employability of less educated older residents to help boost their financial security, given falling family sizes.**

CHART 14: MAIN SOURCE OF FINANCIAL SUPPORT FOR ECONOMICALLY INACTIVE RESIDENTS AGED 50 AND OVER BY EDUCATIONAL ATTAINMENT, JUNE 2006



Source: Labour Force Survey, MOM

5.4 Reflecting the traditional role of men as the main breadwinner within the household, nearly all (98%) economically inactive males aged 50 to 64 in Jun 07 had worked before. The proportion of economically inactive females in this age group with work experience was lower at 66%, pulled down by the below secondary educated group where only six in ten had worked before (Table 10).

TABLE 10: PERCENTAGE OF ECONOMICALLY INACTIVE RESIDENTS WITH WORK EXPERIENCE BY GENDER, AGE GROUP AND EDUCATIONAL ATTAINMENT, JUNE 2007

Per Cent

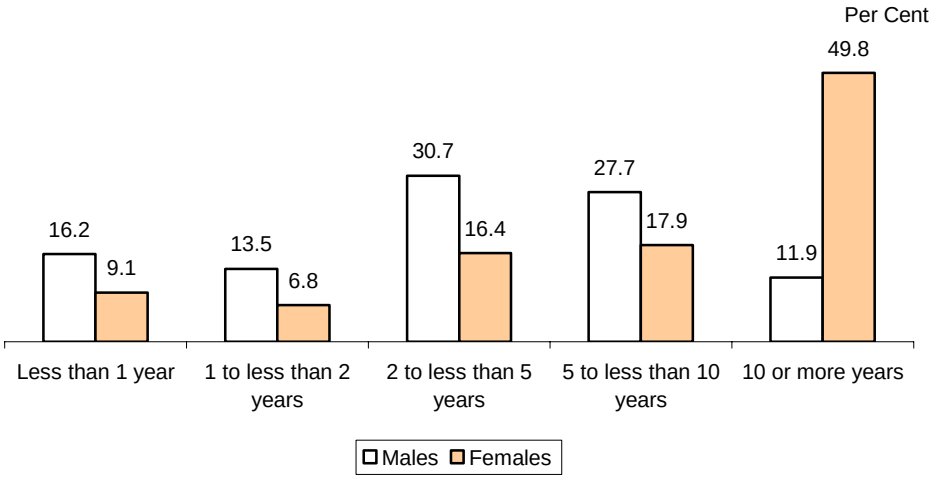
EDUCATIONAL ATTAINMENT	Aged 50 & Over			Aged 50-64		
	Total	Males	Females	Total	Males	Females
TOTAL	**70.8**	**99.2**	**57.5**	**73.5**	**98.1**	**66.1**
Below Secondary	66.0	98.9	52.1	67.8	97.0	60.4
Secondary	85.0	100.0	77.5	83.0	100.0	78.4
Upper Secondary	90.8	100.0	84.1	91.0	100.0	86.9
Polytechnic Diploma	94.4	100.0	86.5	91.5	100.0	80.3
Degree	92.9	99.6	84.3	90.1	99.2	82.0

Source: Labour Force Survey, MOM

Majority of economically inactive women aged 50 to 64 had limited or no labour market experience

5.5 Three in ten or 14,700 economically inactive males aged 50 to 64 who had worked before stopped working only within the last two years, while another 31% (15,200) left their last job between two to less than five years ago. In contrast, one in two (55,700) economically inactive females with work experience had left their last job at least a decade ago (Chart 15).

CHART 15: DISTRIBUTION OF ECONOMICALLY INACTIVE RESIDENTS* AGED 50 TO 64 BY TIME ELAPSED SINCE THEY LEFT THEIR LAST JOB AND GENDER, JUNE 2007



Source: Labour Force Survey, MOM

Note: * – Among those with previous work experience only.

5.6 Altogether, two in three (67% or 113,100) economically inactive females aged 50 to 64 had either stopped working for at least a decade or never worked before. Given the

rapid changes in the economic landscape and job requirements, this group of economically inactive females may lack the required skills to secure employment in today's job market. Hence, **programmes aimed at encouraging older women back to work will need to be complemented by suitable skills upgrading and work preparation programmes, given that the majority of them have limited or no labour market experience**.

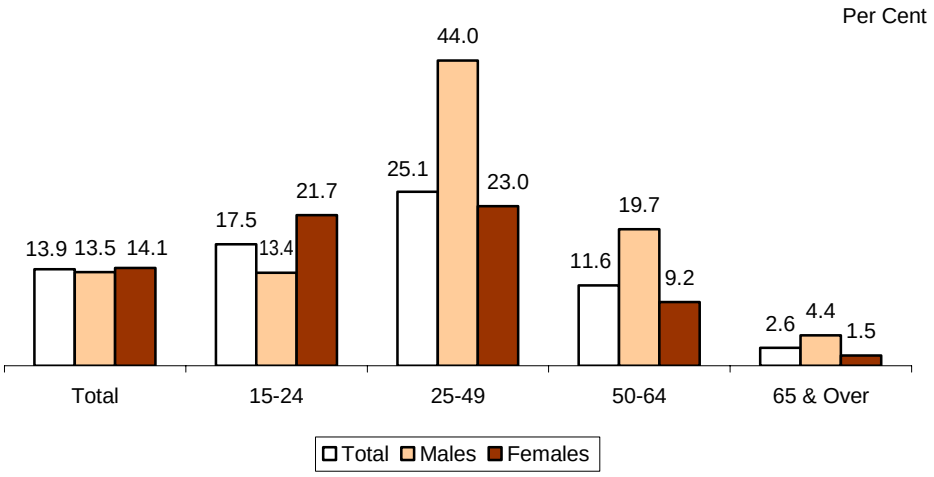
5.7 Close to eight in ten economically inactive residents aged 50 to 64 with work experience were previously employed in non-PMET occupations, led by *plant & machine operators & assemblers* (21%), *cleaners, labourers & related* (20%), *service & sales* (15%) and *clerical* (14%) jobs. By industry, close to three in ten (28%) last worked in *manufacturing*. Another two in three (66%) were previously from the *services* sector, mainly in *community, social & personal services* (19%), *wholesale & retail trade* (14%) and *hotels & restaurants* (13%) (Annex A – Table A4).

6 Potential Entrants

25,500 economically inactive residents aged 50 to 64 intend to look for work within the next two years

6.1 In Jun 07, 25,500 or 12% of the economically inactive residents aged 50 to 64 had the intention to look for a job within the next two years. Within this age group, males were more likely to be potential entrants than females but in absolute terms, women outnumbered men among the pool of potential entrants reflecting the larger base of economically inactive women. Expectedly, the incidence of potential entrants among the economically inactive aged 50 to 64 was lower than those in the prime working age group of 25 to 49 years but higher than those aged 65 & over (Chart 16).

CHART 16: INCIDENCE OF POTENTIAL ENTRANTS BY GENDER AND AGE GROUP, JUNE 2007



Source: Labour Force Survey, MOM

Notes: (1) Potential entrants refer to economically inactive persons who indicated their intention to look for a job within the next 2 years.

(2) Incidence of potential entrants refers to the percentage of economically inactive in the respective category who are potential entrants.

6.2 Although the better educated were more likely to be potential entrants, the below secondary educated formed the largest group (60% or 15,200) among resident potential entrants aged 50 to 64 owing to their large base. Expectedly, older economically inactive residents with recent work experience were more likely to be potential entrants than those who had not worked for extended periods or never worked before. **The majority (71%) of the female potential entrants aged 50 to 64 preferred to work part-time. In contrast, slightly over half (55%) of the male potential entrants in this age group preferred full-time employment** (Table 11).

TABLE 11: RESIDENT POTENTIAL ENTRANTS AGED 50 TO 64 BY CHARACTERISTICS AND GENDER, JUNE 2007

CHARACTERISTICS	Total			Males			Females		
	Number	Incidence (%)	Distribution (%)	Number	Incidence (%)	Distribution (%)	Number	Incidence (%)	Distribution (%)
TOTAL	**25,500**	**11.6**	**100.0**	**9,900**	**19.7**	**100.0**	**15,500**	**9.2**	**100.0**
EDUCATIONAL ATTAINMENT									
Below Secondary	15,200	10.0	59.5	5,500	17.8	55.1	9,700	8.1	62.4
Secondary	6,200	14.5	24.5	2,000	22.3	20.4	4,200	12.4	27.1
Upper Secondary/ Polytechnic Diploma	2,400	15.7	9.4	1,500	26.6	15.4	900	9.1	5.6
Degree	1,700	16.2	6.6	900	18.7	9.2	800	14.0	4.9
WORK EXPERIENCE									
With Work Experience	24,200	15.0	94.9	9,900	20.1	100.0	14,200	12.7	91.6
Left last job:									
Less than 1 year ago	6,500	35.9	25.6	2,900	36.6	29.5	3,600	35.4	23.2
1 to less than 2 years ago	3,400	24.2	13.5	1,700	25.2	17.0	1,800	23.3	11.3
2 to less than 5 years ago	6,000	17.8	23.4	3,000	19.6	30.1	3,000	16.3	19.2
5 to less than 10 years ago	3,900	11.5	15.2	1,900	14.1	19.4	1,900	9.7	12.5
10 or more years ago	4,400	7.1	17.1	400	6.8	4.0	4,000	7.1	25.4
Without Work Experience	1,300	2.2	5.1	–	–	–	1,300	2.3	8.4
PREFERENCE FOR FULL-TIME/ PART-TIME EMPLOYMENT									
Full-Time	10,000	n.a.	39.1	5,500	n.a.	55.0	4,500	n.a.	29.0
Part-Time	15,500	n.a.	60.9	4,500	n.a.	45.0	11,000	n.a.	71.0

Source: Labour Force Survey, MOM

Notes:
(1) Potential entrants refer to economically inactive persons who indicated their intention to look for a job within the next 2 years.
(2) Incidence of potential entrants refers to the percentage of economically inactive in the respective category who are potential entrants.
(3) '–': Nil or negligible.
(4) n.a. – Not applicable.

6.3 An ad-hoc survey on *Barriers to Work* conducted by the Manpower Research and Statistics Department in Oct 06 found that a quarter (25%) of economically inactive men aged 50 to 64 and 28% of women in the same age group who did not intend to look for work within the next two years would consider doing so if one or more motivating factors were present. The availability of *part-time/flexible work arrangements* (males: 54%; females: 61%) followed by *having jobs near home* (males: 42%; females: 53%) were the top two factors that can motivate them to rejoin the workforce. In addition, older respondents also valued *jobs*

with low stress levels and *employers and working environments that are more open and friendly to older workers*. Details are in Annex A – Table A5.

7 Concluding Remarks

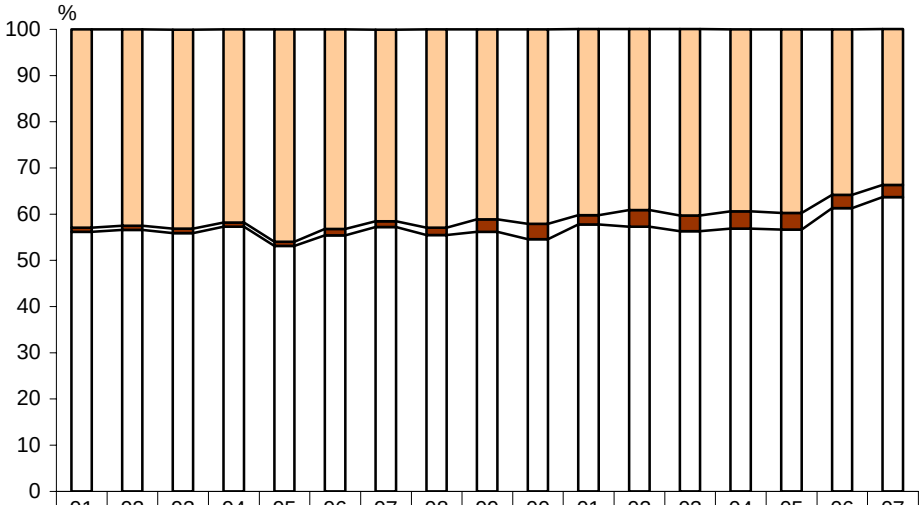
7.1 The sustained economic growth and strong job creation in recent years has benefited the older population and helped lift their employment rate to a new high in Jun 07. As emerging cohorts of the older population are better educated, this augurs well for their employment prospects.

7.2 Nevertheless, reflecting the weaker educational profile of the current cohort of older workers, many are employed in lower-skilled jobs, making them more vulnerable to low-wage employment. As older persons are at greater risk of experiencing job losses and staying unemployed longer, it remains a challenge to enhance their long-term employability, amid the volatile economic environment.

7.3 The study also confirms the importance of the family unit as a key pillar of financial support for older residents, especially among the less educated who are likely to have difficulty accumulating sufficient savings for old age. It underscores the importance of job re-design and training to enhance the employability of less educated older residents to help boost their financial security, given falling family sizes. Specifically, the sizeable share of economically inactive females with limited or no labour market experience suggests that efforts to help them enter the workforce could be complemented by suitable skills upgrading and work preparation programmes, in addition to facilitating part-time and flexible work options.

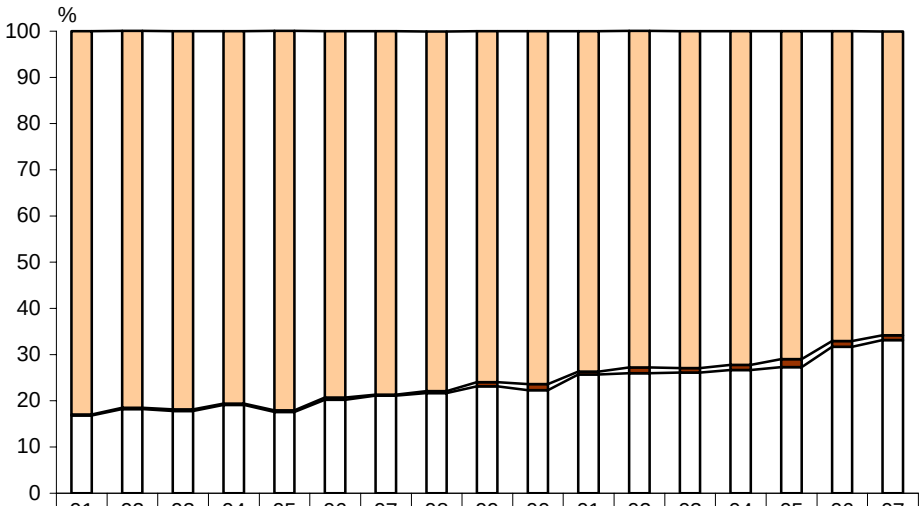
CHART A1: DISTRIBUTION OF MALE AND FEMALE RESIDENT POPULATION AGED 50 AND OVER BY ECONOMIC ACTIVITY STATUS, 1991 TO 2007 (AS AT JUNE) (NON-SEASONALLY ADJUSTED)

(A) MALES



	91	92	93	94	95	96	97	98	99	00	01	02	03	04	05	06	07
Economically Inactive	42.9	42.5	43.0	41.8	46.0	43.2	41.4	42.9	41.1	42.1	40.3	39.2	40.4	39.4	39.7	35.8	33.8
Unemployed	0.9	0.9	1.0	0.9	0.9	1.4	1.3	1.6	2.7	3.3	2.0	3.6	3.4	3.7	3.6	2.9	2.6
Employed	56.2	56.6	55.9	57.3	53.1	55.4	57.2	55.5	56.2	54.6	57.8	57.3	56.3	56.9	56.7	61.3	63.7

(B) FEMALES



	91	92	93	94	95	96	97	98	99	00	01	02	03	04	05	06	07
Economically Inactive	83.0	81.6	81.9	80.6	82.2	79.3	78.7	77.8	76.0	76.4	73.7	72.9	72.9	72.2	71.0	67.1	65.7
Unemployed	0.2	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.5	0.2	0.4	0.9	1.3	0.6	1.2	1.0	1.1	1.7	1.2	1.1
Employed	16.8	18.2	17.8	19.1	17.6	20.2	21.1	21.7	23.1	22.3	25.7	26.0	26.1	26.7	27.3	31.7	33.1

Source: Labour Force Survey (LFS), except data for 1995, 2000 and 2005 which are from the Census of Population 2000 and General Household Survey (GHS) 1995 and 2005.

Notes: (1) Data from Census and GHS may not be strictly comparable with LFS as there are some differences in the survey period. GHS/Census was conducted from Mar/Apr to Aug/Sep whereas LFS was from May to Jul.

(2) The unemployed figures above refer to the percentage of population who were unemployed. This is different from the unemployment rate, which is expressed as a percentage of the labour force.

TABLE A1: EMPLOYMENT RATE OF OLDER POPULATION FOR VARIOUS COUNTRIES BY GENDER AND AGE GROUP, 2007

(A) TOTAL

Per Cent

COUNTRY	50-64	50-54	55-64	55-59	60-64	65 & Over
Singapore	64.2	74.6	56.2	63.3	44.9	14.4
Hong Kong	55.5	67.8	45.9	54.7	31.6	5.3
Japan	70.5	80.9	66.1	74.5	55.5	19.7
South Korea	66.0	73.0	60.6	65.2	55.0	31.1
Taiwan	52.0	64.0	42.2	48.7	31.6	8.1
United States	68.1	77.9	61.8	69.8	51.7	15.5
United Kingdom	65.1	80.2	57.4	69.0	44.7	6.8
France	53.4	79.9	38.3	55.4	15.7	1.4
Germany	61.3	78.3	51.3	66.7	32.9	3.7
Netherlands	60.0	78.0	50.1	66.9	30.8	5.0
Sweden	74.9	85.0	70.1	79.8	60.7	11.1
Total OECD	61.5	74.6	53.7	63.4	41.6	11.6

(B) MALES

Per Cent

COUNTRY	50-64	50-54	55-64	55-59	60-64	65 & Over
Singapore	81.3	90.8	74.0	80.8	62.4	22.9
Hong Kong	72.2	84.9	62.6	72.6	46.6	9.1
Japan	84.9	92.8	81.5	89.8	70.8	29.1
South Korea	80.3	87.5	74.7	80.5	67.5	42.5
Taiwan	68.8	81.0	58.8	66.7	45.6	11.9
United States	73.9	83.8	67.4	75.3	57.3	19.8
United Kingdom	72.5	85.0	66.1	74.2	57.2	9.9
France	56.9	85.5	40.5	58.6	16.6	2.0
Germany	68.7	84.1	59.4	74.6	41.2	5.3
Netherlands	69.4	85.6	60.4	78.9	39.1	8.0
Sweden	77.6	87.0	73.1	81.9	64.4	15.0
Total OECD	71.5	84.1	63.9	73.9	51.4	16.6

(C) FEMALES

Per Cent

COUNTRY	50-64	50-54	55-64	55-59	60-64	65 & Over
Singapore	47.1	58.4	38.6	45.2	28.6	7.8
Hong Kong	38.7	51.0	28.7	36.6	15.6	1.9
Japan	56.5	69.0	51.3	59.5	41.0	12.8
South Korea	51.8	58.4	46.9	50.0	43.2	23.3
Taiwan	35.6	47.2	26.3	31.1	18.4	4.4
United States	62.7	72.4	56.6	64.6	46.6	12.2
United Kingdom	58.0	75.5	49.0	63.9	32.7	4.4
France	50.1	74.5	36.2	52.4	14.8	0.9
Germany	54.1	72.6	43.4	58.9	24.9	2.5
Netherlands	50.6	70.3	39.6	54.7	22.4	2.7
Sweden	72.2	83.0	67.2	77.7	56.8	7.4
Total OECD	51.9	65.4	44.0	53.4	32.5	7.8

Sources: Labour Force Survey, MOM
Hong Kong General Household Survey
Japan Statistics Bureau, Director-General for Policy Planning (Statistical Standards) & Statistical Research and Training Institute Website
Korea National Statistical Office Website
Taiwan Directorate-General of Budget, Accounting and Statistics, Executive Yuan, R.O.C. Website
Current Population Survey, US Bureau of Labour Statistics
OECD Statistics Database

Notes: (1) Data for Singapore pertain to the resident population.
(2) Shaded cells indicate the countries whose employment rate was higher than Singapore's rate.

TABLE A2: DISTRIBUTION OF FULL-TIME EMPLOYED RESIDENTS* BY GROSS MONTHLY INCOME, GENDER AND AGE GROUP, JUNE 2007

Per Cent

GROSS MONTHLY INCOME	Total		Males		Females	
	Aged 15-49	Aged 50 & Over	Aged 15-49	Aged 50 & Over	Aged 15-49	Aged 50 & Over
TOTAL	**100.0**	**100.0**	**100.0**	**100.0**	**100.0**	**100.0**
Below $500	0.7	2.1	0.4	1.1	0.9	4.1
$500 to $999	6.7	19.3	4.6	14.9	9.2	27.9
$1,000 to $1,499	13.4	20.3	12.2	20.7	14.8	19.4
$1,500 to $1,999	14.8	13.1	14.5	14.7	15.1	10.0
$2,000 to $2,499	13.0	9.8	12.3	10.4	13.8	8.8
$2,500 to $2,999	9.6	5.3	9.3	5.4	10.0	5.0
$3,000 to $3,999	14.7	9.2	15.0	9.2	14.5	9.0
$4,000 to $4,999	8.4	5.0	8.9	5.1	7.9	4.9
$5,000 to $5,999	5.6	3.9	6.2	4.4	4.9	3.0
$6,000 to $6,999	3.2	2.3	3.7	2.6	2.4	1.7
$7,000 to $7,999	2.3	1.8	2.7	2.1	1.7	1.3
$8,000 to $8,999	1.7	1.4	2.2	1.5	1.1	1.2
$9,000 to $9,999	1.1	0.7	1.4	0.8	0.7	0.5
$10,000 & Over	4.9	5.7	6.6	7.0	2.9	3.2

Source: Labour Force Survey, MOM

Note: * – Data exclude full-time National Servicemen.

TABLE A3: DISTRIBUTION OF UNEMPLOYED RESIDENTS AGED 50 AND OVER BY MAIN REASON FOR WANTING TO GET A JOB AND EDUCATIONAL ATTAINMENT, JUNE 2006

Per Cent

MAIN REASON FOR WANTING TO GET A JOB	Total	Below Secondary	Secondary	Upper Secondary/ Polytechnic Diploma	Degree
TOTAL	**100.0**	**100.0**	**100.0**	**100.0**	**100.0**
Need money for current expenses	66.4	74.6	70.6	42.0	37.2
Need money for future financial security	11.5	8.1	10.7	14.2	28.7
Need something to occupy my time	6.3	6.9	7.1	6.1	1.9
Want to lead an active life/ Have social contact at work	6.1	3.6	2.7	15.2	18.2
Do not want to be dependent on others for money	4.9	4.3	5.3	10.2	1.9
Others	4.8	2.5	3.6	12.3	12.2

Source: Labour Force Survey, MOM

TABLE A4: ECONOMICALLY INACTIVE RESIDENTS* AGED 50 TO 64 BY PREVIOUS INDUSTRY AND OCCUPATION, JUNE 2007

CHARACTERISTICS	Number	Distribution (%)
TOTAL	**161,300**	**100.0**
PREVIOUS INDUSTRY (SSIC 2005)		
MANUFACTURING	45,400	28.2
CONSTRUCTION	7,500	4.7
SERVICES	106,700	66.1
Wholesale & Retail Trade	22,800	14.1
Transport & Storage	10,300	6.4
Hotels & Restaurants	21,100	13.1
Information & Communications	2,700	1.7
Financial Services	5,600	3.5
Real Estate & Leasing Services	2,900	1.8
Professional Services	3,000	1.8
Administrative & Support Services	8,400	5.2
Community, Social & Personal Services	30,000	18.6
OTHERS^	1,700	1.0
PREVIOUS OCCUPATION (SSOC 2005)		
Managers, Working Proprietors & Senior Officials	12,600	7.8
Professionals	9,500	5.9
Technicians & Associate Professionals	13,300	8.2
Clerical Workers	23,000	14.3
Service & Sales Workers	24,400	15.1
Production Craftsmen & Related Workers	11,900	7.4
Plant & Machine Operators & Assemblers	34,100	21.1
Cleaners, Labourers & Related Workers	31,500	19.5
Others+	900	0.6

Source: Labour Force Survey, MOM

Notes: (1) * – Among those with previous work experience only.
(2) ^ – Includes Agriculture, Fishing, Quarrying, Utilities and Sewerage & Waste Management.
(3) + – Includes Agricultural & Fishery Workers and Workers Not Classifiable by Occupation.

TABLE A5: FACTORS THAT WOULD MOTIVATE ECONOMICALLY INACTIVE RESIDENTS AGED 50 TO 64* TO REJOIN THE WORKFORCE, OCTOBER 2006

RANK	Males		Females	
	Motivating Factor	%	Motivating Factor	%
1	Find jobs that are part-time or have flexible work arrangements	54.2	Find jobs that are part-time or have flexible work arrangements	61.0
2	Find jobs near home	41.7	Find jobs near home	53.0
3	Find jobs which have low stress levels	41.7	Find jobs which have low stress levels	27.4
4	Perceive the employers and the working environment are more open and friendly to older workers	35.4	Perceive the employers and the working environment are more open and friendly to older workers	24.4
5	Find jobs with reasonable pay	25.0	Find jobs that do not require working on shifts/weekends	22.0
6	Find jobs that do not require working on shifts/weekends	20.8	Find jobs with reasonable pay	18.9
7	More information on job opportunities	18.8	Affordable training opportunities for skills upgrading	8.5
8	Affordable training opportunities for skills upgrading	10.4	If my children were older	6.7
9	Affordable elder care facilities/ support for aged family members	2.1	More information on job opportunities	4.9
10	If my children were older	2.1	Affordable elder care facilities/ support for aged family members	4.9
11	Affordable child care facilities for children	–	Affordable child care facilities for children	3.7

Source: Survey on Barriers to Work, 2006, MOM

Notes:
(1) * – Among those who did not intend to look for a job within the next 2 years and can be motivated to rejoin the workforce.
(2) Respondents are allowed to indicate more than 1 motivating factor.
(3) '–': Nil or negligible.
(4) The Survey on Barriers to Work, 2006 effectively covered 2,355 economically inactive residents, comprising older individuals aged 50 to 64 with work experience and females in their prime working age of 25 to 49 years (including those who have never worked before).

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☐ Too detailed ☐ Just right ☐ Too brief

	Excellent	Good	Average	Poor
4. Overall, how would you rate this report?	☐	☐	☐	☐

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